vice chancellor and the Jordanian Embassy a letter of complaint by the students who were harassing Qays, alleging that Qays was hurting their religious sentiments! This letter was forwarded without even a preliminary inquiry. Later, of course, all democratic norms were discarded when Qays was locked out of his TTH room, and officers of the examination branch colluded in his harassment by delaying his thesis evaluation.

While it was quite natural for Qays, an Arab from Jordan, to make friends with the lone teacher of Arabic in the university library, in the wake of S.A.R. Geelani's arrest, this friendship became the cause of his continuous harassment by the CID and the Special Cell in Delhi. Communalism and stereotyped notions of terrorism got intrinsically intertwined and Qays fell victim to this vicious combination.

That Qays was repeatedly taken for questioning by the CID and the Special Police Cell is perhaps understandable, but why he was detained at the Lampur detention centre at the FRRO, when he himself had reported there to inform them of his departure, is intriguing. Even though the court allowed the FRRO to deport Qays, the judges were not convinced of the arguments given by the State. Secondly, the police attempt to drag him out of the detention centre on a Sunday evening in order to produce him in court in connection with the habeas corpus petition on Monday, is highly suspect. Thirdly, why did the police so desperately want to pack Qays' baggage and not allow him to do it himself?

These questions seem to take us to the terrorist attack on Parliament. With the judgement in the Parliament case before us, we know that the Police claimed that the original conspirators of the attack were not educated, and that Geelani, being an educated man, played a crucial role as the conspiracy unfolded. Geelani, thus, was a vital link in the police version of the attack. But—as the high court itself was to later observe in its judgement—there was no evidence to link Geelani with the conspiracy. The police, of course, was aware of this quite basic weakness in its case. Where evidence does not exist, the police fabricates it—this, again, has been noted by the courts. Therefore, the strange case of Qays: it is entirely likely that the police turned to him as a last resort to nail Geelani.

Could it be that Qays was taken to the Lampur detention centre so that the police could secure some 'confession' incriminating Geelani? Could it be that the police was so interested in managing his luggage because it wanted to plant some physical evidence in support of the confession? And could it be